

to ask for help—about one-third of pregnant women get constipated, so your doctor has heard it all before.

FOCUS ON PARTNERS

You may be eligible for paternity pay and leave if you are the father, the husband or partner of the mother, including same-sex partners, the adopter, or the intended parent (if it's surrogacy). The amount of leave and pay will depend on your company policy and how long you have worked there (see [Going back to work](#)). Speak to your human resources department now to find out your rights and whether your company offers additional perks. To maximize the time you can take off once the baby is born, figure out how much vacation you have left and consider saving up days.